DEFENCE JOURNEY

CDS Mock Test 1

Practice test in the CDS pattern with answer key and explanations

CDS | MOCK 1

TIP: Time: 45 minutes. Questions: 40 (English 15, General Knowledge 15, Elementary Maths 10). Marking: +1 for a correct answer, −1/3 for a wrong answer, 0 if left blank. This is a short practice test in the CDS pattern, not the full-length paper. OTA candidates can skip the Maths part. Check the answer key on the last page after you finish.

Part A: English

Q1. Choose the word closest in meaning to MEAGRE.

(A) Scanty
(B) Plentiful
(C) Heavy
(D) Rich

Q2. Choose the word opposite in meaning to OBSOLETE.

(A) Old
(B) Modern
(C) Ancient
(D) Rare

Q3. Fill in the blank: Many a student ___ failed in this test.

(A) has
(B) were
(C) are
(D) have

Q4. Fill in the blank: The teacher, along with his students, ___ present.

(A) are
(B) have been
(C) was
(D) were

Q5. Fill in the blank: She is capable ___ doing the job.

(A) to
(B) of
(C) at
(D) for

Q6. Choose the correct sentence.

(A) He is more junior to me.
(B) He is junior from me.
(C) He is junior to me.
(D) He is junior than me.

Q7. What does the idiom 'to cry wolf' mean?

(A) To be very brave
(B) To raise a false alarm
(C) To hunt animals
(D) To cry loudly

Q8. One word for 'a government by the few':

(A) Autocracy
(B) Democracy
(C) Oligarchy
(D) Monarchy

Q9. Change to indirect speech: She said, "I will come tomorrow."

(A) She said that she will come tomorrow.
(B) She said that she would come the next day.
(C) She said that I would come the next day.
(D) She said that she would come tomorrow.

Q10. Choose the correct passive form of: 'The police arrested the thief.'

(A) The thief was arrested by the police.
(B) The thief has been arrested by the police.
(C) The thief was being arrested by the police.
(D) The thief is arrested by the police.

Q11. Fill in the blank: Had I known, I ___ come earlier.

(A) would
(B) had
(C) will have
(D) would have

Q12. Which sentence is grammatically correct?

(A) The number of student are increasing.
(B) The number of students is increasing.
(C) The number of students are increasing.
(D) A number of students is absent.

Q13. Choose the correct spelling.

(A) Acommodation
(B) Acomodation
(C) Accomodation
(D) Accommodation

Q14. Choose the word opposite in meaning to ZENITH.

(A) Top
(B) Summit
(C) Nadir
(D) Peak

Q15. Find the error: 'Each of the boys (A) / have (B) / done (C) / his work (D).'

(A) B
(B) C
(C) A
(D) D

Part B: General Knowledge

Q16. The Battle of Plassey was fought in the year

(A) 1764
(B) 1857
(C) 1757
(D) 1526

Q17. Who gave the slogan 'Do or Die'?

(A) Bhagat Singh
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Subhas Chandra Bose
(D) Bal Gangadhar Tilak

Q18. The Indian National Congress was founded in

(A) 1885
(B) 1857
(C) 1920
(D) 1905

Q19. Which is the longest river of peninsular India?

(A) Narmada
(B) Godavari
(C) Kaveri
(D) Krishna

Q20. The Tropic of Cancer does NOT pass through

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Gujarat
(C) West Bengal
(D) Odisha

Q21. Which soil is best suited for cotton?

(A) Alluvial soil
(B) Laterite soil
(C) Black soil
(D) Desert soil

Q22. Fundamental Rights are given in which part of the Constitution?

(A) Part II
(B) Part III
(C) Part IV
(D) Part V

Q23. Who is the Supreme Commander of the Indian Armed Forces?

(A) The President
(B) The Defence Minister
(C) The Chief of Defence Staff
(D) The Prime Minister

Q24. The minimum age to become a member of the Lok Sabha is

(A) 35 years
(B) 30 years
(C) 21 years
(D) 25 years

Q25. The headquarters of the Reserve Bank of India is in

(A) Kolkata
(B) Chennai
(C) Mumbai
(D) New Delhi

Q26. Which instrument is used to measure atmospheric pressure?

(A) Barometer
(B) Thermometer
(C) Hygrometer
(D) Anemometer

Q27. The SI unit of force is

(A) Joule
(B) Watt
(C) Pascal
(D) Newton

Q28. Deficiency of which vitamin causes night blindness?

(A) Vitamin C
(B) Vitamin A
(C) Vitamin B
(D) Vitamin D

Q29. The Officers Training Academy (OTA) is located at

(A) Chennai
(B) Hyderabad
(C) Dehradun
(D) Pune

Q30. Kargil Vijay Diwas is celebrated on

(A) 16 December
(B) 15 January
(C) 4 December
(D) 26 July

Part C: Elementary Mathematics

Q31. The HCF of 12 and 18 is

(A) 36
(B) 6
(C) 9
(D) 3

Q32. The LCM of 4, 6 and 8 is

(A) 48
(B) 12
(C) 16
(D) 24

Q33. 20% of 250 is

(A) 50
(B) 25
(C) 60
(D) 40

Q34. A shirt bought for ₹500 is sold for ₹600. The profit per cent is

(A) 16.67%
(B) 20%
(C) 10%
(D) 25%

Q35. The simple interest on ₹2000 at 5% per annum for 3 years is

(A) ₹200
(B) ₹250
(C) ₹330
(D) ₹300

Q36. A train 100 m long runs at 36 km/h. The time taken to cross a pole is

(A) 12 seconds
(B) 10 seconds
(C) 8 seconds
(D) 6 seconds

Q37. A can do a work in 10 days and B in 15 days. Together they finish it in

(A) 6 days
(B) 5 days
(C) 8 days
(D) 12.5 days

Q38. The value of $(a + b)^2 - (a - b)^2$ is

(A) $2a^2$
(B) 2ab
(C) 0
(D) 4ab

Q39. The area of a circle of radius 7 cm is ($\pi = 22/7$)

(A) 154 cm^2
(B) 308 cm^2
(C) 49 cm^2
(D) 44 cm^2

Q40. The sum of the angles of a triangle is

(A) 360°
(B) 180°
(C) 270°
(D) 90°

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	A	2	B	3	A	4	C	5	B
6	C	7	B	8	C	9	B	10	A
11	D	12	B	13	D	14	C	15	A
16	C	17	B	18	A	19	B	20	D
21	C	22	B	23	A	24	D	25	C
26	A	27	D	28	B	29	A	30	D
31	B	32	D	33	A	34	B	35	D
36	B	37	A	38	D	39	A	40	B

Explanations

Q1. (A) Meagre means small in quantity, i.e. scanty.

Q2. (B) Obsolete means out of date. The opposite is modern or current.

Q3. (A) *Many a* is followed by a singular noun and a singular verb.

Q4. (C) *Along with* does not change the number of the verb. The subject is 'teacher' (singular).

Q5. (B) *Capable* takes the preposition *of*.

Q6. (C) *Junior* is followed by *to*, not *than*.

Q7. (B) It means to give a false warning so that people do not believe you the next time.

Q8. (C) Oligarchy is rule by a small group. Autocracy is rule by one person.

Q9. (B) *Will* becomes *would*, and *tomorrow* becomes *the next day*.

Q10. (A) Simple past active becomes was/were + past participle.

Q11. (D) Third conditional: If + past perfect, would have + past participle.

Q12. (B) *The number of* takes a singular verb. *A number of* takes a plural verb.

Q13. (D) Accommodation has a double 'c' and a double 'm'.

Q14. (C) Zenith is the highest point. Nadir is the lowest point.

Q15. (A) *Each* is singular, so the verb should be *has*, not *have*.

Q16. (C) Robert Clive defeated Siraj-ud-Daulah at Plassey in 1757.

Q17. (B) Gandhiji gave this call during the Quit India Movement in August 1942.

Q18. (A) A. O. Hume helped found it in 1885. W. C. Bonnerjee was its first president.

Q19. (B) The Godavari is about 1,465 km long.

Q20. (D) It passes through Gujarat, Rajasthan, MP, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, West Bengal, Tripura and Mizoram.

Q21. (C) Black (regur) soil holds moisture and suits cotton.

Q22. (B) Part III (Articles 12 to 35). Directive Principles are in Part IV.

Q23. (A) The President of India is the Supreme Commander.

Q24. (D) Lok Sabha: 25 years. Rajya Sabha: 30. President: 35.

Q25. (C) The RBI was set up in 1935 and is headquartered in Mumbai.

Q26. (A) A barometer measures air pressure. A hygrometer measures humidity.

Q27. (D) Force = mass × acceleration, measured in newtons.

Q28. (B) Vitamin A is needed for the retina.

Q29. (A) OTA is in Chennai. IMA is in Dehradun, NDA near Pune, and the Air Force Academy at Dundigal.

Q30. (D) 26 July marks the 1999 Kargil victory. 16 December is Vijay Diwas for 1971.

Q31. (B) $12 = 2^2 \times 3$ and $18 = 2 \times 3^2$. HCF $= 2 \times 3 = 6$.

Q32. (D) LCM $= 2^3 \times 3 = 24$.

Q33. (A) $250 \times 20/100 = 50$.

Q34. (B) Profit = 100. $100/500 \times 100 = 20\%$.

Q35. (D) SI $= 2000 \times 5 \times 3/100 = ₹300$.

Q36. (B) 36 km/h = 10 m/s. Time = 100/10 = 10 seconds.

Q37. (A) $(10 \times 15)/(10 + 15) = 150/25 = 6$ days.

Q38. (D) $(a^2 + 2ab + b^2) - (a^2 - 2ab + b^2) = 4ab$.

Q39. (A) $\pi r^2 = (22/7) \times 49 = 154\ cm^2$.

Q40. (B) The three angles of any triangle add up to 180°.